Financial Studies Department (FSD)

Faculty Members

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Programs Offered

The Financial Studies Department (FSD) offers three programs – Accounting, Finance and Banking, and Business IT Management. Each program leads to a Bachelor of Business Administration degree. The details of each program follow.

Accounting Program

Program Overview

If you want to be financially literate and play a key role in business decision-making, Accounting is the right career choice for you.

Accounting is about the measurement, analysis, and communication of financial information pertinent to the economic health of business entities. Accountants devise and use financial information systems to enable investors, creditors, managers, and regulators to make sound decisions.

There are two main tracks in accounting: Financial Accounting and Management Accounting. If the purpose is to provide information to investors and creditors for resource allocation and decision-making, we are talking about financial accounting. But if the purpose is to provide information to managers to plan, evaluate performance, and make decisions, we are talking about management accounting.

To obtain a Bachelor of Business Administration degree in Accounting, the student must complete 99 credit hours. These span University requirements (UR), College requirements (CR), and Program requirements (PR). The allocation of the credit hours is shown in the following table:

BBA in Accounting (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	-	-	18	12	30	30
College Requirement	6	-	35	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	31	3	53	12	99	100

I. University Requirements (General Education)

The list of the university's required courses and their descriptions is presented in the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section in this catalog.

II. College Requirements

The list of the college-required courses and their descriptions is presented in the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section in this catalog.

III. Program Requirements

A. Mandatory requirements

The mandatory courses for the Accounting program are listed in the table below.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BACC 305	Intermediate Accounting I	3	BACC 205
BACC 310	Cost Accounting	3	BACC 255
BFIN 350	Credit and Financial Analysis	3	BFIN 300
BACC 405	Intermediate Accounting II	3	BACC 305
BACC 450	External Auditing	3	BACC 405
BACC 460	Advanced Financial Accounting	3	BACC 405
BACC 465	Taxation	3	BACC 405
	Major Elective	3	
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217 Senior Standing
BADM490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing

B. Major Electives

As part of the Bachelor of Business Administration in Accounting program, the student must study 3 credit hours of major electives. Major electives could be upper-level courses in accounting or closely related business areas. These courses allow students to focus on a specific area for in-depth knowledge and understanding. Meanwhile, they introduce flexibility into the program, allowing the integration of emerging topics.

In consultation with the academic advisor, the student should select the elective course that best aligns with their needs and aspirations. It is highly recommended that the student register for these courses after completing the Departmental requirements. The table below lists some recommendations for major elective courses:

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BACC 350	Accounting Information Systems	3	BACC 205, BITM 300
BACC 455	Internal Auditing	3	BACC 405
BACC 470	Forensic Accounting and Fraud Detection	3	BFIN 300, BACC 205
BADM 480	Independent Studies	3	Advisor's approval

Moreover, under certain conditions specified by the department and subject to the advisor's approval, a student may take BADM 480 (independent studies) as a substitute for a program's mandatory course. The course's description is below.

C. Entrepreneurship

The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. Prerequisite: Senior Standing.

D. Co-op Work Experience

Each student must complete 8 weeks of practical training in a field related to their interests. The Co-op experience is usually fulfilled during the summer semester of the third year in the program. The Co-op office matches the Co-op assignment with the student's field of study and the employer's interest. A faculty member follows up on a student's progress throughout the Co-op period by conducting field visits and ensuring that the student's performance is aligned with their aspirations and the employer's needs. Students must then submit formal reports and posters and make formal presentations about their Co-op experience. While ENGL 217 and Senior Standing are prerequisites for co-op training, the program must stipulate additional conditions.

Career Opportunities

Accounting offers a wide range of careers in various types of organizations. In addition to the traditional roles of financial reporters and analysts, internal and external auditors, cash managers, and cost controllers, accountants can serve as advisors and strategic contributors across different areas of the organization. Moreover, accountants typically work in government agencies, businesses, industries, and organizations.

Program Goals and Student Learning Outcomes

The purpose of the Accounting Program at the College of Business Administration of Rafik Hariri University is an integrative composite of four main dimensions: General and Specialized Business Knowledge, Communication, Critical Thinking, and Growth Potential.

General & Specialized Business Knowledge

Goal 1	Prepare graduates with effective professional competence in critical accounting tasks and activities.
Outcome 1	Apply essential business knowledge and skills in problem-solving and decision-making.
Outcome 2	Prepare Financial Statements in accordance with International Financial Reporting Standards, Generally Accepted Accounting Principles, and best practices.

Communication

Goal 2	Equip graduates with the knowledge and skills to secure placements in financial and managerial accounting positions.
Outcome 3	Demonstrate written and oral English communication skills adequate for challenging entry- and middle-level professional positions and self-employment.

Critical thinking

Goal 3	Promote analytical and critical thinking in approaching business issues and problems.
Outcome 4	Identify business problems, analyze them, and present plausible solutions.

Ethics and Social Responsibility

Goal 4	Raise awareness about ethics and social responsibility to promote better business for a better community.
Outcome 5	Recognize ethical dilemmas in business and respond to them in accordance with standard codes of conduct, ethical principles, and best practices.

Study Plan

The Bachelor of Business Administration in Accounting encompasses 99 credit hours over six semesters and two summer sessions. The second summer session should be dedicated to the Community Engagement Experience. Meanwhile, the third session should be for the Co-op work experience. The following study plan serves as a roadmap for a smooth progression toward graduation.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
Year 1, Fall Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 205	Financial Accounting	3	
BADM 215	Personal Development and Management	1	
BMGT 200	Introduction to Management	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210.
BITM 200	Information Technology Essentials	3	
ENGL 210	English Composition and Rhetoric	3	Placement
MATH 207	College Algebra*	3	Placement
Year 1, Spring Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 255	Managerial Accounting	3	BACC 205
BADM 225	Business Math	3	Placement
BADM 235	Business Research Methodology	1	
BADM 250	Business Statistics	3	
BMKA 200	Introduction to Marketing	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210
ENGL 217	Professional English Communication	3	ENGL 210
Year 2, Fall Semester (18 Credits)			
BACC 305	Intermediate Accounting I	3	BACC 205
BACC 310	Cost Accounting	3	BACC 255
BADM 230	Business Law	3	
BECN 301	Microeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BFIN 300	Financial Management I	3	BACC 205

Year 2, Spring Semester (18 Credits)			
BACC 405	Intermediate Accounting II	3	BACC 305
BECN 302	Macroeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BFIN 350	Credit and Financial Analysis	3	BFIN 300
BITM 300	Business IT Management	3	BITM 200
BITM 350	Fundamentals of Data Analytics	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351.
	Humanities / Fine Arts Elective	3	
Year 2, Summer Semester (0 Credits)			
BADM 290	Community Engagement Experience	0	
Year 3, Fall Semester (15 Credits)			
BACC 450	External Auditing	3	BACC 405
BACC 465	Taxation	3	BACC 405
BADM 355	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility	3	Junior Standing
BADM 420	Quantitative Methods for Business	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351 or Senior Standing
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Spring Semester (15 Credits)			
ARAB 212	Arabic Language and Communication	2	
BACC 460	Advanced Financial Accounting	3	BACC 405
BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	2	Senior Standing
	Community & Sustainability	1	Co-req.: ENGL 210
	Major Elective	3	
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Summer Semester (1 Credit)			
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217 Senior Standing

* Students exempted from this course based on their score on the mathematics placement exam will select a free elective course as a substitute for it.

Courses Description

I. Mandatory Courses

Descriptions of the major mandatory courses are given below.

BACC 305	**Intermediate Accounting I**	**3(3,0)**
This course is an in-depth study of accounting issues related to the measurement and reporting of assets, liabilities, and income in accordance with IFRS. It enables students to evaluate and understand financial accounting concepts and practices. The course covers the accounting framework, the use of the time value of money in accounting, and the preparation of financial statements. The course also includes a detailed accounting study of current and noncurrent assets. **Prerequisite:** BACC 205.		

BACC 310	Cost Accounting	3(3,0)
This course is a continuation of BACC 255. It offers students comprehensive knowledge of cost allocation, process costing, and joint and product costing. Moreover, the course deals with the costs of spoilage and waste. It allows students to better understand the relationships among quality, time, and cost. The course also concentrates on capital budgeting and cost control system analysis issues. **Prerequisite:** BACC 255.		

BACC 405	Intermediate Accounting II	3(3,0)
This course is a continuation of BACC 305. It concentrates on measuring and reporting liabilities and the various components of stockholders' equity. It introduces students to dilutive securities and their effect on earnings per share. The course emphasizes fair value, proper accounting for financial instruments, and new developments related to revenue recognition and reporting accounting changes and errors. Moreover, the course covers the preparation and presentation of the statement of cash flows in accordance with IFRS. **Prerequisite:** BACC 305.		

BACC 450	External Auditing	3(3,0)
This course introduces the students to international financial accounting standards and general auditing standards. It will enable the students to develop and apply auditing programs and procedures to various financial statement items. It concentrates on auditing the main business cycles such as the inventory, revenue, expenditure, and investment cycles. **Prerequisite:** BACC 405		

BACC 460	Advanced Financial Accounting	3(3,0)
This course is designed to enable students to address specialized financial accounting topics, including consolidated financial statements; accounting practices for forming and liquidating partnerships; accounting for multinational corporations; accounting for branches and segments; accounting for not-for-profit organizations; and governmental accounting. **Prerequisite:** BACC 405.		

BACC 465	Taxation	3(3,0)
This course covers various aspects of the Lebanese taxation system, including methods of tax imposition, taxes based on real profit, computation of taxable profit, tax rates and tax due, taxes on non-residents, fixed assets, holding companies, offshore companies, Insurance companies, financial institutions, tax on employees, tax on movable capital (stocks, interests, dividends, etc.) **Prerequisite:** BACC 405		

BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1(0,1)
The Co-op work experience is designed to provide students with full-time work terms in business, industry, or government. The main thrust of this course is the opportunity to put into practice the major aspects of the student's business education. Special emphasis will be placed on assessing the student's attitude and work ethics. Students will be encouraged to network in the industry and to participate in professional organizations. **Prerequisite:** ENGL 217; Senior Standing.		

BADM 490	Entrepreneurship
The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing	

BFIN 350	Credit and Financial Analysis	3(3,0)
Financial fitness and performance evaluation are core activities for credit officers, loan officers, and financial managers. This course will equip students with the knowledge and tools to conduct sound financial analysis using both public and non-public statements and reports. The main areas of analysis include liquidity, profitability, solvency, leverage, and market performance. **Prerequisite:** BFIN 300.		

II. Elective Courses

Descriptions of major elective courses are given below.

BACC 350	Accounting Information Systems	3(3,0)
This course is designed to give students an in-depth understanding of accounting information systems. It introduces the student to file and database organization, business processes and internal controls, the systems development process, and the management of information systems. Moreover, end-user application software includes "off-the-shelf" accounting software packages and spreadsheets. **Prerequisite:** BACC 205, BITM 300.		

BACC 455	Internal Auditing	3(3,0)
The course develops an understanding and appreciation of the role of internal auditing in an organization. Topics include internal auditing standards, risk assessment, governance, ethics, and audit techniques. **Prerequisite:** BACC 405		

BACC 470	Forensic Accounting and Fraud Detection	3(3,0)
This course will cover the basic concepts of forensic accounting. Topics include detecting, preventing, investigating, and resolving various types of fraud. The course covers many types of financial statement fraud, including asset misappropriation, fraudulent financial statements, tax fraud, and electronic fraud. **Prerequisite:** BFIN 300 and BACC 205.		

BADM 480	Independent Studies	3(3,0)
This course focuses on advancing the student's knowledge in their specialization through independent research and application on current or emerging topics, as approved by the assigned faculty member. **Prerequisite:** Advisor's approval.		

IV. Non-Business Programs Courses

BACC 210	SME's Financial Planning and Accounting	3(3,0)
This subject provides an overview of today's accounting and financial planning techniques for facility management for professionals who intend to operate small businesses, work as independent contractors, or work as freelancers. Using computer software applications, technical professionals should be able to perform budgeting, materials procurement and management, work order systems, work planning and scheduling, cost control techniques, preparation, and understanding of simplified financial statements. At least one-third of the coverage in this course is devoted to hands-on practical applications.		